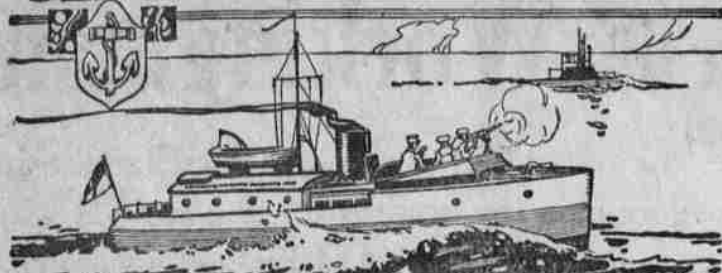


SEA SLUG STORIES



Thrilling Tales of U Boat Hunting, Told by an American Boy Who Served For Months With the British Patrol and Who Did the Thrilling and Perilous Work That Is Now Being Done by Hundreds of Other American Boys.

Thrown Into the Sea.

"I was swinging her round, which I guess is what brought her stern quarter on the mine. I thought a thunder-clap had detonated right under my feet. I went spinning off the bridge like a catapult. I don't pretend even to know whether I was conscious as I hurtled through the air, but the shock of the cold water brought me to. I was some yards from the destroyer and started to swim toward her. I could see some of the men lying on the deck, others crawling up the companionways and some crawling about on the deck. A very few were standing on their feet and doing the best they could to help the others.

"There wasn't an officer in sight, and I knew then they must all have been killed or at least knocked unconscious. "My leg hurt me so that I could scarcely move it, but I kept on struggling. The water tasted oily, and I could make out that oil was escaping from the destroyer and spreading all over the surface of the sea, which was as calm as if it were a mirror.

"Suddenly there was a flash. A little tongue of flame darted out of the entrance of the wounded destroyer and ran a short way over the surface of the oily patch, then died. Presently came another tongue. Then half a dozen began to lick. A dozen! Twenty! Great God, there were a thousand, and they were licking the surface of the water as though a thousand hell cats were lapping a giant bowl of scalding milk.

"They ran toward me, and I may have screamed. If I didn't it was because I was too scared. I struck out away from the destroyer. The tongues ran toward me faster than I could swim, then seemed to curl back upon themselves, but only to dart out once more, and each time they darted nearer to me.

"If only I could get beyond that oil. The sun glimmered in rainbow colors on its surface, but the only thing it meant to me was I was still in it. The smell of it in my nostrils and the taste of it in my mouth so terrified my imagination that I could feel the piercing pain of burns already.

"I envied the men who had been smashed to jelly quickly in the ward room.

"At last the flames were upon me. I felt them on my neck. I dove and drove myself forward under the water, but when I came up my hair was singed and I could smell it burning. After that I do not remember what happened. I am here; that is all I know."

Leaped Into Burning Oil.

One of the mates (sailors) who had been on deck saw the officer just as the flames were reaching him. The very sea around the destroyer seemed on fire. It meant almost certain death to leap in it, but the mate leaped.

He swam under water as far as he could. When he came up the flames licked around him. He filled his lungs with stifling, burning hot air and dove again. Bit by bit he reached the officer, who had apparently lost all consciousness, although he still was struggling feebly—just enough to keep him afloat, but rapidly weakening.

When once he had his arm under the officer's shoulder the rescuer could no longer dive and he had to swim slowly, supporting his heavy burden with streaks of flame shooting all round him and laying him in flames.

He knew by now and had done whatever is in his power to do for the man who saved him.

Always Exciting at Dover.

I think the average person could get excitement enough during a short stay in Dover to last almost a lifetime.

There is almost always something doing at sea, ashore or in the air. You can hear the big guns in Belgium and France on a still day.

One morning I was talking with some acquaintances on the parade grounds.

Somebody shouted, "Aeroplane!" Everybody's head went back, and all eyes began to stare into the sky. Sure enough, there were a number of them.

Over a Mine Field.

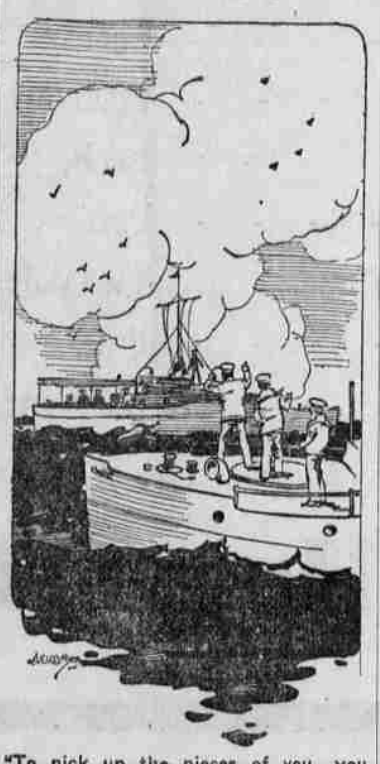
It wasn't long after this experience of the destroyer with the mine that I went on a run in an M. L. (motor launch) for submarine chasers from Dover. The subaltern in command of the boat was as nervous as the best of them, but he hadn't had much nautical experience. What he knew about navigation and the king's regulations could have been engraved on the face of a dime. As we were running back into the harbor they began signaling us from shore. The subaltern looked at the signals through his glasses, looked in the book, grunted and went blissfully ahead. I rather felt at the time that he didn't know what the signals meant just from the sort of self-conscious way in which he put his glasses

down. Of course I did not know the British code.

Those fellows hate to let on they are stumped. They'll race neck and neck with death rather than let it be known they lack any of the qualifications.

A moment later the signal flags were hauled down and run up again. We held our course, and the flags were lowered and raised several times, as if trying to attract our attention to them on shore.

Presently a man began wigwagging frantically, while the flag signals were



"To pick up the pieces of you, you blithering idiot!"

still at the masthead. Then a gun boomed.

"What in the deuce is all the row?" inquired our sub innocently.

Right on we blazed our way, without changing our course a hair, and before we were well into the harbor a whole swarm of M. L.'s and other craft came swooping down on us.

"What you got the navy with you for?" asked our sub through the megaphone when he was within speaking distance of the leading craft.

"To pick up the pieces of you, you blithering idiot!" said the Brass Hat in command. "Run alongside here for orders."

We ran alongside, and if orders is what our smart young sub got I don't want any.

"You've just come over a new mine field, you young numskull!" roared the Brass Hat. "It's only luck—bad luck for us, I'm thinking—that saved you from being blown higher than a kite. You go ashore. Didn't you see those signals?"

"Yes, sir," said the sub.

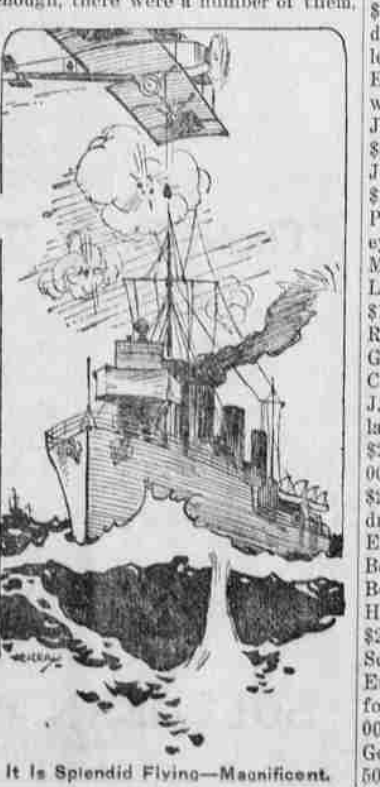
"Well, you go ashore, and don't you get within fifty yards of the water again till you know the book and can read signals backward and upside down. The navy wouldn't lose much in you, but you've got a few men on board with you that we'd like to keep."

As the Brass Hat ching-chugged away in his launch there was indignation in the lines of the very boat itself.

"What's all the bally row about signals?" said our sub in a groined tone of voice. "We're here all right, aren't we? I say!"

He had been about as near death as he will come before he actually goes over, but that was all he had to say about it. I knew I was pale. I felt it. And my knees had a tendency to drum against each other.

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It is Splendid Flying—Magnificent.

so high they were little more than specks. Out of the hangars on the cliffs our own planes began to be run. The anti-aircraft guns—Archies they call them in England—began to bark. But bark was all they did, for we could see the shrapnel burst way short of the enemy fliers.

The British were quick in getting up, but the planes were so high that they had passed over us before our boys were close enough to do them any damage. We had mostly heavy hydroplanes at that time, not speedy enough to keep up with the swift German war machines.

Presently there was another cry. Two more machines had been spotted. They were flying low.

"Must be a couple of our own," says some one.

"No, they're Boches, all right," reports an officer with glasses.

"They must be traveling about 100 miles an hour. One swooped out over the harbor. Something shoots out from beneath it. There is the roar of an explosion. A bomb has burst forty yards or so from a destroyer lying at anchor.

Anti-aircraft guns begin sprinkling shrapnel around the plane which is out over the harbor. It is almost close enough now for machine guns. Several begin to drum. The aeroplane itself is using a machine gun against the destroyers. It swoops down.

"Must be hit," says a man at my elbow.

Attacks the Destroyers.

It does seem so, for the plane is careening straight for the wireless mast of another destroyer, just skimming the water. It is splendid flying—magnificent.

With machine gun spitting the pilot shoots gracefully upward, just clearing the wireless mast and spraying lead all over the deck of the vessel. Then he sweeps on over the shore in the direction his fellows had gone.

"They'll get"—begins the man at my elbow, but whatever else he was going to say was lost in a roar that shook the earth we stood on.

We turn round and gaze at a jagged plume which has been blown in the parade ground too close to us to be comfortable. In our interest in the aeroplane fight with the destroyer we had forgotten the one which circled over the bluff.

The people of Dover must be accustomed to such raids, for there is no excitement, no scurrying for protection. Every one now turns his attention to the second plane. Straight over the town it flies. There is another roar—rather a muffled one. It has reduced to dust and splinters several rooms in the hotel, including the suite de luxe.

One more crash before the Boche becomes a speck in the distance. This time the bomb leaves a hole in the paved street where before there had been a cart and horse.

One by one our planes returned without having caught the enemy. One fellow, the fastest of them all, was out until 4 o'clock that evening, but he had not been able to overtake the Boches.

Editor's Note:—This is the last of the "Sea Slug Stories." If you have enjoyed these stories, why not write The Courier a letter and say so. We would deeply appreciate it.

COUNTY COURT

(Continued from Page 4)

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GUS KUHN, President



Hogg Bros., \$32.50; Coast Chemical Co., \$11.00; Chris Hartman, \$1.50. CIRCUIT COURT—Oregon City Enterprise, \$12.00; W. P. Harris, \$2.00; Doctors Mount, \$5.00; Huntley Drug Co., \$1.50; Harry W. Greaves, \$4.00; J. M. Tracy, \$2.00; Dan Lyons, \$2.00; H. H. Hughes, \$2.00; L. E. Dimick, \$8.40; C. M. Lake, \$6.40.

JUSTICE PEACE—Jewell DuBall, \$4.50; W. J. Wilson, \$1.70; A. C. Howland, \$1.20; George Gardner, \$1.20; L. P. Horton, \$1.20; George J. Hall, \$1.20; W. R. Wentworth, \$1.20; J. C. Sawyer, \$1.20; E. Harrington, \$1.40; J. E. Jack, \$1.20; George E. Swafford, \$1.20; E. E. Teeple, \$1.20; H. H. Hughes, \$1.20; S. O. Dillman, \$1.20; D. E. Frost, \$2.60; J. N. Sievers, \$5.30; D. Smith, \$4.50; Vina Smith, \$4.50; Kenneth Smith, \$4.50; J. Langseth, \$4.50; Mrs. L. Langseth, \$4.50; A. E. Joyner, \$2.75.

CORONER—J. N. Sievers, \$15.80; Charles Gates, \$5.00; A. E. Joyner, \$3.00; J. F. Albright, \$10.00.

SURVEYOR—J. C. Sullivan, \$9.00; H. H. Johnson, \$6.40.

INSANE—Hugh S. Mount, \$5.00; A. E. Joy